

Delhi Sultanate: Art and Architecture

*Qutbuddin Aybak built 'Adhai Din Ka Jhopara' mosque in Ajmer and 'Quwwat-ul-Islam' mosque near Raipithora Fort in Delhi. Construction of **Qutub Minar** was started in Delhi by Aybak, which was completed by Iltutmish. *Iltutmish built Sultangarhi, Hauj-e-Shamsi, Shamsi Eidgaah, Jama Masjid Shamsi (Badayun). Atarkin-ka-Darwaza (Nagaur) etc. Alauddin Khalji built **Alai Darwaza** near the Qutub Minar. It was built with red sandstones and white marble, and it was completed in 1311 AD. *Alauddin Khalji built Hazar Sitoon and Hauz-e-Alai in the Dargah of Nizamuddin Auliya. Ukha Mosque (Bayana Rajasthan) was built by Malik Kafur Sultani during reign of Sultan Mubarakshah Khalji.

*The tomb of Sultan Balban, located in Mehrauli, New Delhi, built by himself, was the first tomb built in a purely Indo-Islamic style in India. ***Ghiyasuddin Tughluq** (1320 - 25 AD), after the foundation of the Tughluq dynasty he established a city in Delhi and named it '**Tughluqabad**'. *The Moth Masjid was built during the reign of Sikandar Lodi. *Sikandar Lodi's tomb was built by Sultan Ibrahim Lodi. *In the celebration of Malwa Vijay, Rana Kumbha of Mewar built **Kirti Stambh** (pillar). Kirti Stambha was built by Rana Kumbha after his victory over Malwa. It was built under the supervision of Jaita while Atri and Mahesh were its panegyrists.

1. Use of paper started in India in -

- (a) 12 century CE (b) 13 century CE
- (c) 14 century CE (d) 15 century CE
- (e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (a)

Paper was first discovered in China. Use of paper started in India in 12th century CE. The oldest evidence of paper in India is preserved at Ashutosh Museum, Kolkata, which houses paper from 1105 CE called Panchraksha.

2. Which Sultan built Alai Darwaza?

- (a) Iltutmish (b) Balban
- (c) Alauddin Khalji (d) Firuz Tughluq

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Alai Darwaza was built by Alauddin Khalji. It has a domed entrance which was constructed using red sandstone and is adorned with white marble. It was completed in 1311 AD by Turkish craftsmen. It is one of the first buildings in India in Indo-Islamic architectural style.

3. The Horse-Shoe arch was first introduced in the -

- (a) Tomb of Iltutmish

- (b) Tomb of Ghiyas-ud-din Tughluq
- (c) Alai Darwaza
- (d) Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

The Horse-Shoe arch was first introduced in the Alai Darwaza. It was built by Alauddin Khalji.

4. Who among the following did not contribute to the construction of Qutub Minar :

- (a) Qutbuddin Aybak (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Alauddin Khalji (d) Firuz Shah Tughluq

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

Qutbuddin Aybak, the first Muslim ruler of Delhi Sultanate, commenced the construction of Qutub Minar, but could complete only its basement. Which was completed by Iltutmish. In the time of Firozshah Tughlaq, the fourth floor of the Qutub Minar was damaged, on which he got the fifth floor constructed along with the restoration of the fourth floor. Qutub Minar has been named after Qutbuddin Bakhtiar Kaki, the famous Sufi saint. Sultan Alauddin Khalji did not contribute in building the Qutub Minar.

5. Who among the following Sultans built the fifth storey of Qutub Minar?

- (a) Qutbuddin Aybak
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Firuz Shah Tughluq
- (d) Sikandar Lodi

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

6. Consider the following statements about Minars (Tower) of middle India.

- (1) The Qutub Minar, built in the Thirteenth century, is a 180-feet-high tapering tower divided into five storeys.
- (2) Chand Minar, built in the fifteenth century, is a 210-feet-high tapering tower divided into four storeys.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) (1) only (b) (2) only
- (c) Both (1) and (2) (d) None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

The Qutub Minar, built in the thirteenth century, is a 238 feet (72.5 M) high tapering tower divided into five storeys. The minar is a mix of polygonal and circular shapes. It is largely built of red and buff sandstone with some use of marble in the upper storey.

Chnad Minar, built in the fifteenth century, is a 210 feet high tapering tower divided into four stories. Painted Peach now, its facade once boasted of chevron patterning on the encaustic tile work and bold bands of Quranic verses.

7. **India's first tomb constructed in the Indo-Islamic style was –**

- (a) Humayun's Tomb (b) Balban's Tomb
(c) Aybak's Tomb (d) Alauddin's Tomb

U.P. P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (b)

The Tomb of Ghiyasuddin Balban is located in Mehrauli, New Delhi. It was built in 1287 AD in rubble masonry. The tomb is a building of historical importance in the development of Indo-Islamic architecture.

8. **The first true arch in the Sultanate memorial could be seen in**

- (a) Iltutmish's tomb
(b) Tomb of Balban
(c) Alai Darwaza
(d) Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

Tomb of Balban is located in Mehrauli, New Delhi. It was here that first true arches made their appearance in India.

9. **Consider the following :**

1. Tughluqabad fort
2. Lodi Garden
3. Qutub Minar
4. Fatehpur Sikri

The correct chronological order in which they were built is :

- (a) 3, 1, 4, 2 (b) 3, 1, 2, 4
(c) 1, 3, 2, 4 (d) 1, 3, 4, 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (b)

Qutub Minar	–	Qutbuddin Aybak (1206-10AD) and Iltutmish (1211-36 AD)
Tughluqabad fort	–	Ghiyasuddin Tughluq (1320-1325 AD)
Lodi Garden	–	Lodi dynasty (1451-1526 AD)
Fatehpur Sikri	–	Akbar (1556-1605 AD)

Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

10. **Match List – I with List – II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists.**

- | | |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------|
| List – I (Building) | List – II (Builders) |
| A. Sultan Garhi | 1. Alauddin Khilji |
| B. Red Palace | 2. Qutbuddin Aibak |
| C. Jamat Khana Masjid | 3. Iltutmish |
| D. Dhair Din Ka Jhopra | 4. Balban |

Code :

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| | A | B | C | D |
| (a) | 3 | 4 | 2 | 1 |
| (b) | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| (c) | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |
| (d) | 4 | 3 | 1 | 2 |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (*)

Correctly matched list is as follows—

- | | |
|---------------------|------------------|
| List – I | List – II |
| (Building) | (Builders) |
| Sultan garhi | Iltutmish |
| Red Palace | Balban |
| Jamat Khana Masjid | Khizr Khan |
| Dhair Din Ka Jhopra | Qutbuddin Aybak |

Note: Jamat Khana masjid is the oldest monument found in the dargah complex of Hazrat Nizamuddin Aulia. It was built by Khizr Khan, son of Sultan Alauddin Khalji.

11. **Which of the following is not correctly matched?**

- | | |
|------------------------|----------------|
| Building | Builder |
| (a) Lal Mahal | – Balban |
| (b) Hindola Mahal | – Hoshang Shah |
| (c) Jahaz Mahal | – Ghiyasuddin |
| (d) Lal Darwaja Mosque | – Bibi Raje |

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Ans. (b)

The correct match is as follows :

- | | |
|--------------------|------------------------|
| Building | Builder |
| Lal Mahal | – Balban |
| Hindola Mahal | – Ghiyas-ud-din Khalji |
| Jahaz Mahal | – Ghiyas-ud-din Khalji |
| Lal Darwaja Mosque | – Bibi Raje |

12. **The composer of 'Kirti-Stamba Prashasti' was :**

- (a) Somdeva (b) Jaita
(c) Napa (d) Atri Kavi

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

Kirti Stambha was built by Rana Kumbha after his victory over Malwa. Kirti Stambh was built by Jaita while the panegyrists of Kirti Stambh were Atri and Mahesh.